# DARK KNIGHT DISPATCH

## OVERVIEW Week 9

Data · Wed Nov. 4, 1:36 PM PT

OVERVIEW | CALLS | FIELD | POSITIONS

CONTROLS

YAHOO lineups & waivers | BLITZ live play-by-play | LIVE Dark Knight Live | ONE-PAGE the overview link

## DK I 4-4-0 vs MR. RODGERS' NEIGHBORHOOD 3-5-0

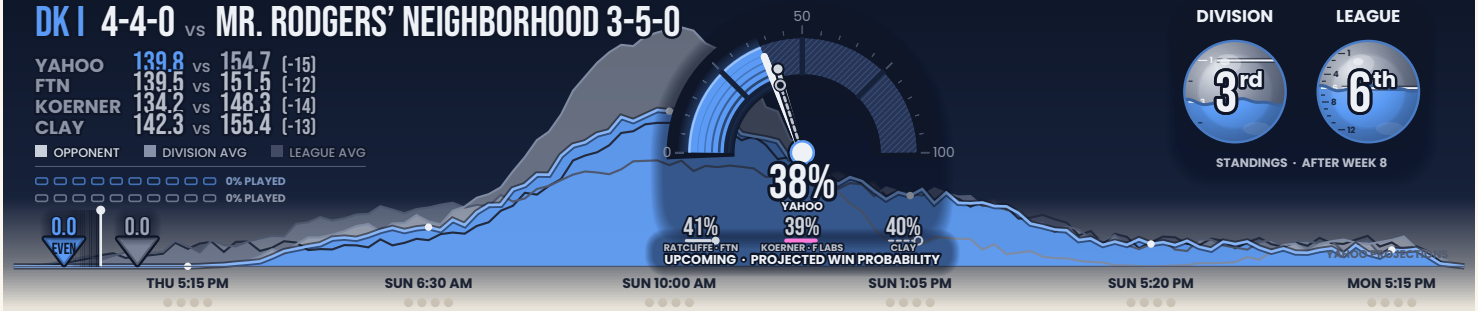
| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| YAHOO | 139.8 | 154.7 | (-15) |
| FTN | 139.5 | 151.5 | (-12) |
| KOERNER | 134.2 | 148.3 | (-14) |
| CLAY | 142.3 | 155.4 | (-13) |

OPPONENT · DIVISION AVG · LEAGUE AVG

0% PLAYED · 0% PLAYED

DIVISION 3rd · LEAGUE 6th

STANDINGS · AFTER WEEK 8




All data as of Wed Nov. 4 · Yahoo 1:36 PM · Gotham 1:37 PM · Sleeper 1:13 PM PT

Check before kickoff: McCaffrey (Q), Kelce (Q). · Edge: Chiefs over Packers, +3.6

## DK II 4-4-0 vs HECTOR FOOTBALL 3-5-0

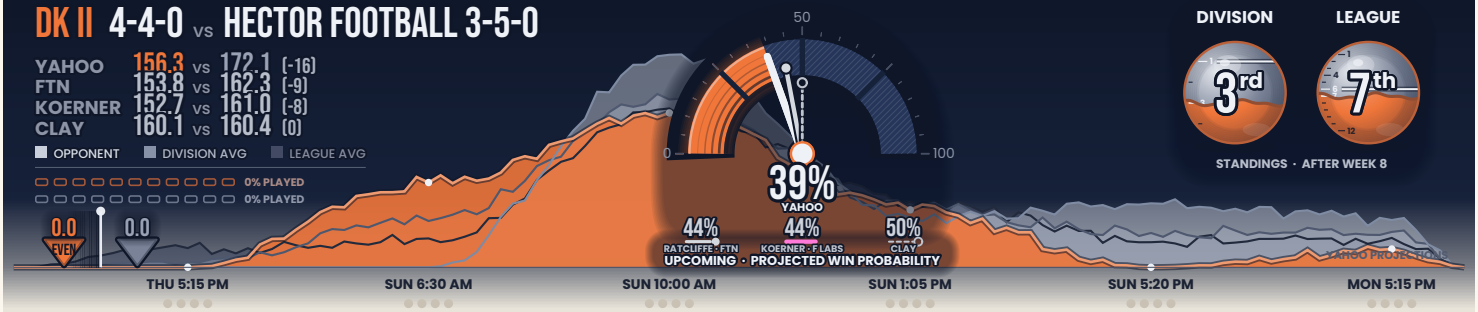
| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| YAHOO | 156.3 | 172.1 | (-16) |
| FTN | 153.8 | 162.3 | (-9) |
| KOERNER | 152.7 | 161.0 | (-8) |
| CLAY | 160.1 | 160.4 | (0) |

OPPONENT · DIVISION AVG · LEAGUE AVG

0% PLAYED · 0% PLAYED

DIVISION 3rd · LEAGUE 7th

STANDINGS · AFTER WEEK 8




All data as of Wed Nov. 4 · Yahoo 1:36 PM · Gotham 1:37 PM · Sleeper 1:13 PM PT

Fix the lineup: Montgomery has no game or is out.

## DK III 3-5-0 vs MALY'S BETTER HALF 3-5-0

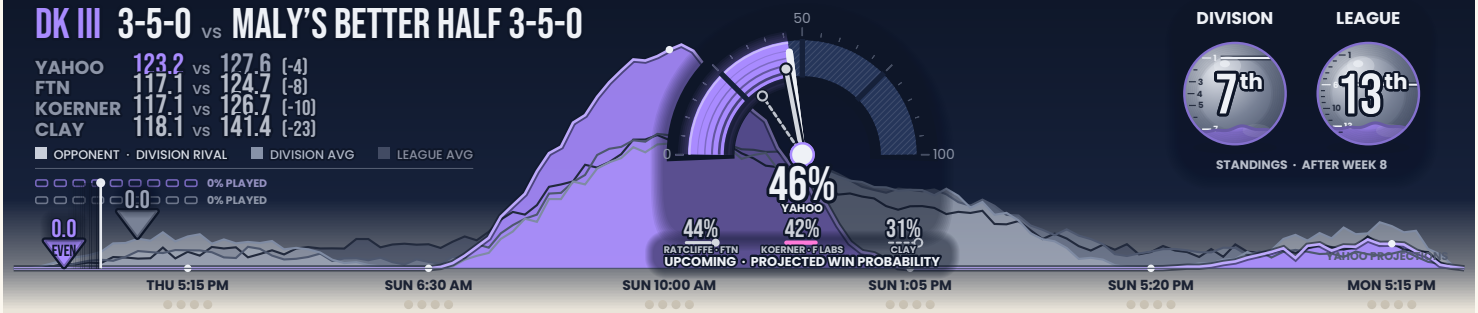
| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| YAHOO | 123.2 | 127.6 | (-4) |
| FTN | 117.1 | 124.7 | (-8) |
| KOERNER | 117.1 | 126.7 | (-10) |
| CLAY | 118.1 | 141.4 | (-23) |

OPPONENT · DIVISION RIVAL · DIVISION AVG · LEAGUE AVG

0% PLAYED · 0% PLAYED

DIVISION 7th · LEAGUE 13th

STANDINGS · AFTER WEEK 8




All data as of Wed Nov. 4 · Yahoo 1:36 PM · Gotham 1:37 PM · Sleeper 1:13 PM PT

Fix the lineup: Montgomery has no game or is out.

## DK IV 8-8-0 vs ALAN'S TEAM 8-8-0

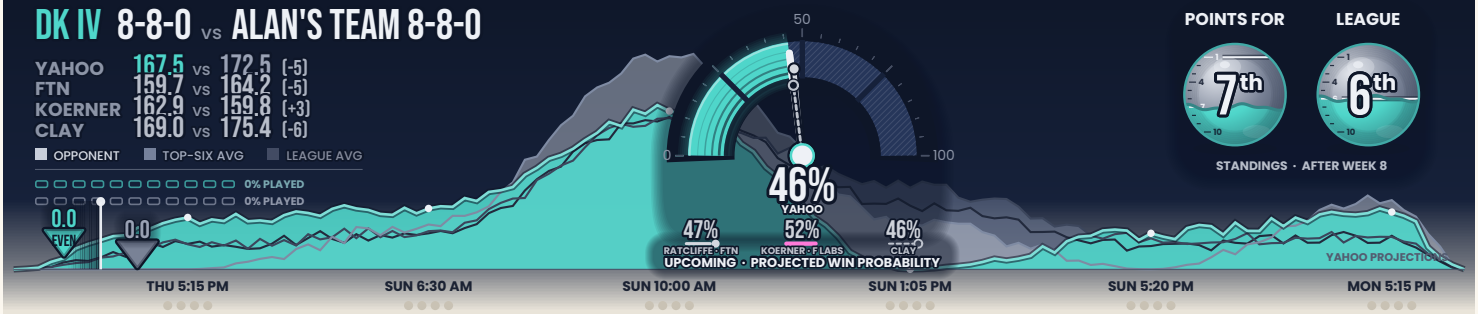
| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| YAHOO | 167.5 | 172.5 | (-5) |
| FTN | 159.7 | 164.2 | (-5) |
| KOERNER | 162.9 | 159.8 | (+3) |
| CLAY | 169.0 | 175.4 | (-6) |

OPPONENT · TOP-SIX AVG · LEAGUE AVG

0% PLAYED · 0% PLAYED

POINTS FOR 7th · LEAGUE 6th

STANDINGS · AFTER WEEK 8




All data as of Wed Nov. 4 · Yahoo 1:36 PM · Gotham 1:37 PM · Sleeper 1:13 PM PT

Check before kickoff: Kelce (Q). · Edge: Jefferson over Moore, +5.9

WEEK 9, built Wed Nov 04 2026 01:37 PM PT. YAHOO: each lineup as set on Yahoo's matchup pages (pulled Wed Nov 04 01:36 PM PT); final games at actual, the rest as projected. GOTHAM: our engine (usage x rate x status, 2025 prior; run Wed Nov 04 01:37 PM PT). SLEEPER: Sleeper's public projections priced in each league's scoring, from the GitHub job (Wed Nov 04 01:13 PM PT). Kickers and defenses: Sleeper's number in both Gotham and Sleeper (no source beats a flat average there). METER: center = Yahoo's own posted win chance; left Gotham, right Sleeper, same spread math; gold ticks = share played. MOUNTAIN: Yahoo by kickoff window, Pacific; league and division layers from every team's matchup page (Wed Nov 04 01:36 PM PT). Every source checked: none missing, stale or short.

## ACTION ITEMS · WEEK 9

What needs you, most urgent first · the full case is on each league's page · every move is your call

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| DK II | David Montgomery is out. Bench him | before his Sun 1:05 PM kickoff |
| DK III | David Montgomery is out. Bench him | before his Sun 1:05 PM kickoff |
| DK I | Christian McCaffrey is questionable - latest (ESPN, Nov 4): McCaffrey (hamstring) will not participate in... | before his Sun 1:05 PM kickoff |
| DK I | Travis Kelce is questionable - latest (ESPN, Nov 2): Kelce caught five of seven targets for 67 yards in Su... | before his Sun 10:00 AM kickoff |
| DK II | Travis Kelce is questionable - latest (ESPN, Nov 2): Kelce caught five of seven targets for 67 yards in Su... | before his Sun 10:00 AM kickoff |
| DK IV | Travis Kelce is questionable - latest (ESPN, Nov 2): Kelce caught five of seven targets for 67 yards in Su... | before his Sun 10:00 AM kickoff |

THE ADVICE, GRADED: Scout head-to-head calls graded: 184, the pick outscored the man he would replace 43 times (23%). Lineup alarms: 24 graded, 24 fixed in time. Open calls waiting on game

## Gotham closest. Gotham ahead by 0.1 points a man.

Running total, Weeks 2–8, 809 men. Every number is the one posted before kickoff, graded against the final stat line in that league's scoring.

## THIS WEEK · WEEK 8

14 of 14 games final · grows every build until Monday night · one week is noise

| YAHOO | Week 8 | GOTHAM | Week 8 | SLEEPER | Week 8 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 6.4 points off a man | 69% start/sit calls right | 6.6 points off a man | 66% start/sit calls right | 6.5 points off a man | 68% start/sit calls right |
| 86 men graded | | 86 men graded | | 86 men graded | |

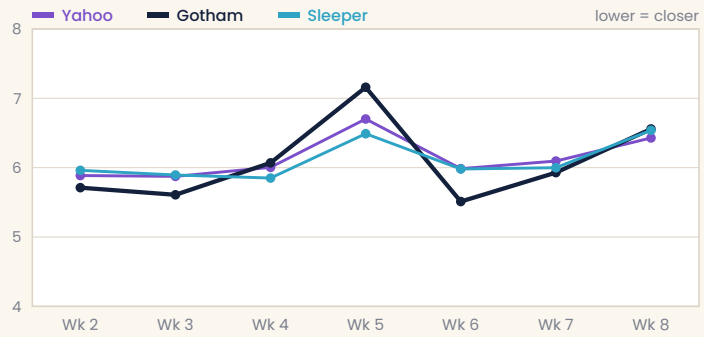
## RUNNING TOTAL · WEEKS 2-8

The real signal · Weeks 2–4 graded by hand Oct 8, Week 5 on automatic

| YAHOO | Weeks 2–8 | GOTHAM | Weeks 2–8 | SLEEPER | Weeks 2–8 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 6.1 points off a man | 67% start/sit calls right | 6.0 points off a man | 66% start/sit calls right | 6.0 points off a man | 67% start/sit calls right |
| 809 men graded | | 809 men graded | | 809 men graded | |

## THE TREND · BY POSITION

Average points off a man, week by week · and where each source misses most



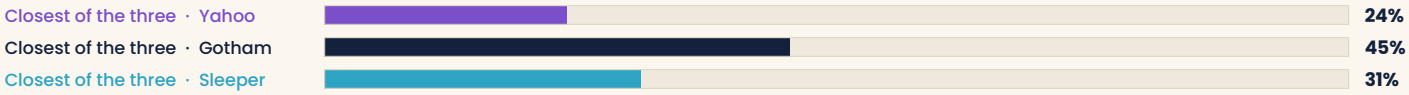

| POS | | Yahoo | | Gotham | | Sleeper | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| QB | 139 | 7.6 | 60% | **7.4** | 59% | 7.5 | 58% |
| RB | 242 | 6.0 | 74% | **6.0** | 74% | 6.1 | 74% |
| WR | 313 | 5.6 | 65% | **5.5** | 64% | **5.5** | 65% |
| TE | 115 | 5.6 | 64% | **5.5** | 63% | 5.7 | 61% |

Points off a man, then start/sit calls right. Green = closest at that position.

## WHEN THEY DISAGREE

The three split by 4 points or more · the red box on the Field Report · the hard calls

55 men split 4+ points. Misses run bigger on them: Yahoo 7.7 points off, against 5.9 when the three agree.




## BIGGEST MISSES · WEEK 8

Where all three were furthest off · green = the closest of the three on that man

| PLAYER | LEAGUE | YAHOO | GOTHAM | SLEEPER | ACTUAL | WHAT HAPPENED |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Joe Burrow, QB | DK IV | **26.1** | 25.9 | 25.9 | **52.5** | Beat every number by 26.4 |
| Zay Flowers, WR | DK IV | 18.7 | 18.6 | **18.4** | **0.0** | Under every number by 18.4 |
| Jacoby Brissett, QB | DK II | 23.1 | **21.5** | 22.3 | **4.2** | Under every number by 17.3 |

Gotham's rule since Oct 11: a game a man left hurt (under 35% of snaps when he usually plays 60% or more) no longer counts against his number.
Oct 13 test (Weeks 2-5, 505 player-weeks): three changes kept, Gotham 6.61 to 6.35 pts a man; practice trim off; middle-starter nudge did not help.

## SCORECARD

UPCOMING

**UNDERDOG** 139.8 to 154.7

Mr. Rodgers' Neighbo... · 3–5, 10th of 12

Yahoo's projection for both lineups

| | |
|---|---|
| DK I | 139.8 |
| Opp | 154.7 |

Projected margin -15.0 · Yahoo, lineups as set

41% FTN · 38% YAHOO · 40% GOTHAM

Win chance before kickoff — Yahoo center, FTN left, Gotham right

| | |
|---|---|
| **Players** | Tagged: McCaffrey (Q), Kelce (Q) |
| **Record** | 4–4 entering Week 9 |
| **Standing** | 6th of 12 entering the week · 9th in points |

1 2 3 4 5 6 | 7 8 9 10 11 12

Playoff spots | Playoff line

## OUTLOOK

WEEK 9

DK I goes in as the underdog. Yahoo projects 139.8 to 154.7 against Mr. Rodgers' Neighborhood (3–5, 10th of 12), a 15.0-point gap. Win chance: Yahoo 38%, FTN 41%, Gotham 40%. The three engines agree. At 4–4, 6th of 12: on the playoff line, with no room to give back.

**Before kickoff.** McCaffrey is Q; Kelce is Q. FTN and Gotham both would start Douglas over Godwin (+1.4). The best lineup closes about 1.4 of the 15.0-point gap, so the rest has to come from the starters beating their projections - check the Scout for an add that lifts this week.

**Where it's won and lost.** Your edges: McCaffrey over C. Hubbard at RB (+3.1). Theirs: C. Brown over Black at RB (-12.5); C. Lamb over Pickens at WR (-6.1). Gotham is cooler than Yahoo on London (14.6 vs 18.0) - his workload doesn't support Yahoo's number, so lean on him less.

Week 9, looking ahead — Yahoo read Wed Nov. 4, 1:36 PM PT

## STARTERS

Lineup as set on Yahoo · Week 9

| PLAYER | MARKERS | POS | TEAM | SLOT | VS | BYE | PROJECTED BEFORE KICKOFF YAHOO | FTN | GOTHAM | SCORE | NEXT 3 | AVG | OPPONENT | SCORE | DELTA |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Jayden Daniels | 3 | QB | WAS | QB | vs LA | 7 | 22.3 | 21.3 | 19.9 | — | 21.4 | 23.9 | P. Maho... | 24.3 | |
| Christian McCaffrey INJ Q | 1 | RB | SF | RB | vs LV | 8 | 24.5 | 24.9 | 25.5 | — | 24.3 | 23.6 | C. Hubba... | 21.3 | |
| Kaelon Black | 1 Q17 ↑ | RB | SF | RB | vs LV | 8 | 8.1 | 10.2 | 7.8 | — | 7.1 | 6.4 | C. Brown | 20.6 | |
| George Pickens | 1 ↓ | WR | DAL | WR | @ IND | 14 | 14.2 | 13.4 | 13.8 | — | 13.9 | 13.0 | C. Lamb | 20.2 | |
| Drake London | 2 | WR | ATL | WR | vs CIN | 11 | 18.0 | 15.1 | 14.6 | — | 14.1 | 13.8 | M. Nabers | 18.2 | |
| Travis Kelce INJ Q | 2 ↑ | TE | KC | TE | vs NYJ | 5 | 12.2 | 10.2 | 12.2 | — | 11.2 | 11.7 | T. Warren | 13.9 | |
| Stefon Diggs | 1 | WR | WAS | FLEX | vs LA | 7 | 12.1 | 12.7 | 11.7 | — | 13.1 | 13.7 | D. Moore | 12.2 | |
| Chris Godwin Jr. | 2 ↓ | WR | TB | FLEX | @ CHI | 10 | 10.3 | 8.9 | 7.3 | — | 7.5 | 6.7 | B. Corum | 11.1 | |
| Will Reichard | Q03 | K | MIN | K | vs BUF | 6 | 7.6 | 10.1 | — | — | — | — | C. Ryland | 5.9 | |
| Chiefs | Q21 | DEF | KC | DEF | vs NYJ | 5 | 10.6 | 11.3 | — | — | — | — | GB D | 7.0 | |
| **TOTAL** | | | | | | | **139.8** | | | | | | | 154.7 | |

## BENCH

Yahoo projects only the lineup

| PLAYER | MARKERS | POS | TEAM | SLOT | VS | BYE | PROJECTED BEFORE KICKOFF YAHOO | FTN | GOTHAM | SCORE | NEXT 3 | AVG | VALUE |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Jaylen Warren | 3 | RB | PIT | BN | BYE | 9 | — | — | — | — | 20.1 | 21.3 | On bye · back Wk 10 |
| TreVeyon Henderson INJ Q | 2 ↓ | RB | NE | BN | vs GB | 11 | — | 5.9 | 9.9 | — | 9.7 | 7.8 | Depth at RB · 9.7 next 3 |
| Tyler Shough | 1 | QB | NO | BN | vs CLE | 8 | — | 19.3 | 21.6 | — | 21.7 | 22.6 | Depth at QB · 21.7 next 3 |
| Caleb Douglas | 1 | WR | MIA | BN | vs DET | 6 | — | 10.3 | 8.6 | — | 9.4 | 11.9 | Covers Godwin's Wk 10 bye |
| Vikings | Q21 | WR | | BN | BYE | 1 | — | — | — | — | — | — | On bye · back Wk 10 |

## IR

1 of 1 slot used

| PLAYER | MARKERS | POS | TEAM | SLOT | VS | BYE | PROJECTED BEFORE KICKOFF YAHOO | FTN | GOTHAM | SCORE | NEXT 3 | AVG | VALUE |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Travis Etienne Jr. INJ IR | 1 ↓ | RB | NO | IR | vs CLE | 8 | — | — | 0.0 | — | 13.6 | 12.8 | On IR · holds no roster seat |

**F** game final, SCORE is real. No F: still a projection.
**INJ** Yahoo's tag: Q questionable, D doubtful, O out, IR.
**Score** green = beat Yahoo's projection by 3+; red = 4+ short.
**Projected** each source before kickoff; Gotham skips K and DEF.

**Band** around a whole row: he is playing right now.
**Markers** 2 Radar news (count) · Q03 Scout need (days) · D role drift · ↑ playing time up / down
Red = act, gold = watch, green = good. Up to four per man, news first.

**The Scout** is the engine built to find this team's needs: every hole and thin spot, week by week through the playoffs, ranked by what each one costs in wins, with what is needed, when, and who available could fill it. Everything here is a recommendation to talk through. A move becomes an action only once it is decided, and then it goes to the Call Sheet.

**If Christian McCaffrey Sits** — Questionable, starting at RB1 (~24.9 this week). The best lineup without him is ~19.0 pts lower. An add here needs a drop (Dom's call). **Best fills, points added this week and next: Devin Singletary**, NYG RB +5 now, +0 next week (free agent) · **Dylan Sampson**, CLE RB +5 now, +0 next week (free agent) · **Kimani Vidal**, LAC RB +3 now, +0 next week (free agent).

**If Travis Kelce Sits** — Questionable, starting at TE (~10.2 this week). The best lineup without him is ~10.2 pts lower. An add here needs a drop (Dom's call). **Best fills, points added this week and next: Greg Dulcich**, MIA TE +9 now, +0 next week (free agent) · **Tyler Higbee**, LA TE +8 now, +0 next week (free agent) · **Michael Mayer**, LV TE +8 now, +0 next week (free agent).

**Expert Moves** (read Mon Nov 2 2026 8:58 PM PT) Up: Caleb Douglas WR 52  WR 45 · Up: George Pickens WR 19  WR 13 · Up: Chris Godwin Jr. WR 29  WR 24 · Down: Jaylen Warren RB 9  RB 14

## Gate 1 · Needs, in Priority Order

Each slot named on this roster · the target is what the slot will give · measured against the opponent's man that week

**The Defense Won't Hold** — DEF, Season-Long · Target 11.1 pts 21 — Drops Off When Filled

Full strength ~14.9 (Vikings). Wk 9 Chiefs ~11.3 (Vikings has a worse matchup) · Wk 10 Vikings ~11.3 · Wk 11 Vikings ~8.9 (hard matchup vs SF) · Wk 13 Vikings ~12.4 · Wk 14 Vikings ~12.2 · Wk 15 Vikings ~9.0 (hard matchup vs DET) · Wk 16 Vikings ~10.8 (hard matchup vs WAS) · Wk 17 Vikings ~12.7.

**TB DEF** · Scored 6, 4, 6, 8, 11, 9, 29, 28 · Waivers, Clears Nov 7 · Current level ~20.4 a game; rival check: 11 teams would start him over one of their own - JD ($85 left, waiver #8), DIKFORE ($49 left, waiver #6), Rolling With Romo ($75 left, waiver #5), World Of Pain ($54 left, waiver #4), Punching Bag ($66 left, waiver #12), Raider nation ($90 left, waiver #3); BOTH AGREE (Ratcliffe 6.8, engine 5.6 a week); Koerner 6.3 vs Ratcliffe 6.8 this week - experts agree; helps Wks 13-16. · **Adds ~23 pts through Wk 17** (12 in the playoffs) · **This week vs your DEF Chiefs DEF: Ratcliffe 6.8 vs 11.3 · Koerner 6.3 vs 10.6 · Yahoo 5.4 vs 10.6 - WORSE this week**

**A Bye Hits the Backfield** — RB2, Week 9 Fill · Target 10.2 pts 17 — Drops Off After Wk 9

Full strength ~19.8 (Warren). Wk 9 Black ~10.2 (Warren on bye, Black slides in).

No recommendation — nobody available fits.

**The Flex Runs Thin** — FLEX1, Week 11 Fill · Target 10.6 pts 17/4 — Drops Off After Wk 11

Full strength ~12.8 (Pickens). Wk 11 Black ~10.6 (Pickens moves up to WR1, Black slides in).

No recommendation — nobody available fits.

**A Tough Draw for the Backfield** — RB1, Week 11 Fill · Target 21.4 pts 26 — Drops Off After Wk 11

Full strength ~25.1 (McCaffrey). Wk 11 McCaffrey ~21.4 (hard matchup vs MIN).

No recommendation — nobody available fits.

**A Tough Draw for the Tight End Spot** — TE, Week 13 Fill · Target 9.4 pts 01/4 — Drops Off After Wk 13

Full strength ~10.6 (Kelce). Wk 13 Kelce ~9.4 (hard matchup vs LA).

No recommendation — nobody available fits.

**Also on the Board** QB, Week 13 Fill  K, Weeks 10, 15 Fill

## Gate 2 · Available, Could Incrementally Improve the Team

Found by workload, an opening, or a return · priced as if a seat opens · no drops suggested

None this run.

## Gate 3 · Hunches

Written down, aged and graded like any other name

None written yet.

**Checked, Not Assumed** Can't claim: Chris Boswell (PIT K) - you dropped him, and Yahoo blocks claiming back your own drop while he's on waivers. If nobody claims him he's a free agent after Nov 7 and you can add him then. · Stash: Tyler Goodson (DAL RB, free agent) - 26% of the DAL backfield's touches the last three games behind Javonte Williams (~20.9 a game, 70%); the lead job is his if Williams goes down; his own level now ~6.1 · Stash: Roschon Johnson (CHI RB, free agent) - 23% of the CHI backfield's touches the last three games behind D'Andre Swift (~23.7 a game, 77%); the lead job is his if Swift goes down; his own level now ~5.0 · Rising: Gunnar Helm (TEN TE, free agent) - workload jumped to 13.4 expected points last game from 4.0 before; season level ~5.5, not on the Scout's pickup list yet - one more game like it and he is · Rising: Dylan Sampson (CLE RB, free agent) - workload jumped to 13.6 expected points last game from 4.3 before; season level ~9.7, not on the Scout's pickup list yet - one more game like it and he is · Your starter fading: Jaylen Warren (PIT RB) snaps 90% to 62% (typical game), touch share 93% to 59% the last three games; Rico Dowdle (rostered) is taking the work - snaps 0% to 39%, touch share 0% to 41%, level now ~14.4 · Adonai Mitchell (NYJ WR) is on the Positions chart (workload 6.5->9.7; covers Wk11 Drake London, Wk10 Chris Godwin Jr.): adds nothing to the best lineup through Wk 17, real level ~10.7 a game; ranks below the picks above · Courtland Sutton (DEN WR) is on the Positions chart (): adds nothing to the best lineup through Wk 17, real level ~8.9 a game; ranks below the picks above · Darius Cooper (PHI WR) is on the Positions chart (workload 4.1->6.0): adds nothing to the best lineup through Wk 17, real level ~6.4 a game; ranks below the picks above · Justice Hill (BAL RB) is on the Positions chart (workload 7.8->20.8): adds nothing to the best lineup through Wk 17, real level ~7.1 a game; ranks below the picks above

Protected (Dom's call): Travis Kelce, Kaelon Black · Rosters Yahoo Wed Nov 4, 1:36 PM PT (API) · Stats nflverse Wed 1:36 PM PT

# DARK KNIGHT DISPATCH

## POSITIONS • DK I

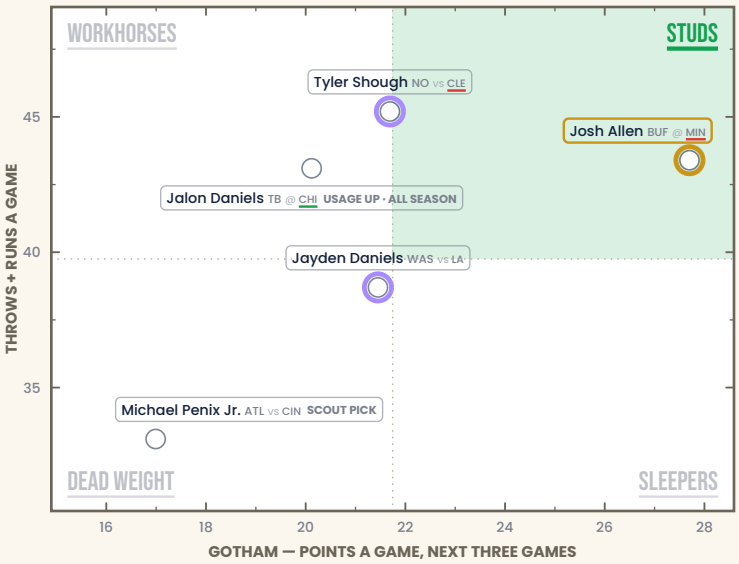
Week 9 · Roles, and the free agents worth a look

Data · Wed Nov. 4, 1:36 PM PT



## QUARTERBACKS

AS OF **WED NOV. 4, 1:13 PM**

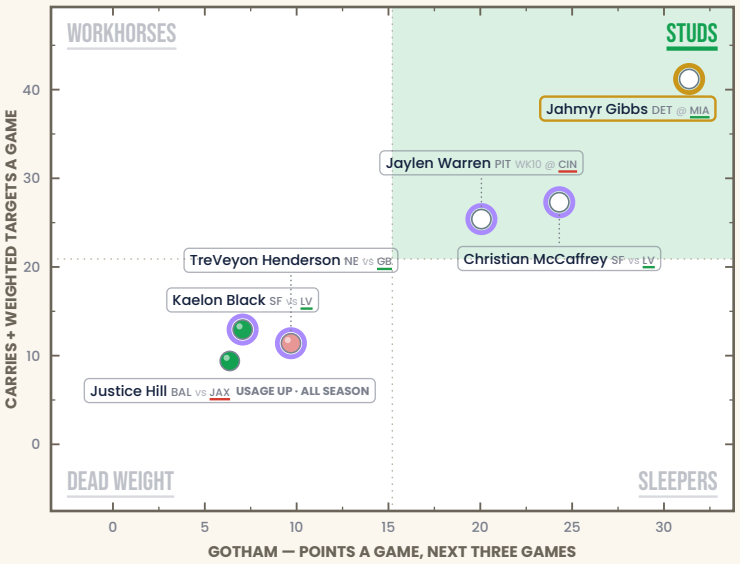



**Floor:** 18.2 a game — 85% of Jayden Daniels, the weakest starter here (21.4).

**Doors:** Jalon Daniels — workload 39.5->50.2; Michael Penix Jr. — Scout pick — adds ~4 pts through Wk 17

## RUNNING BACKS

AS OF **WED NOV. 4, 1:13 PM**

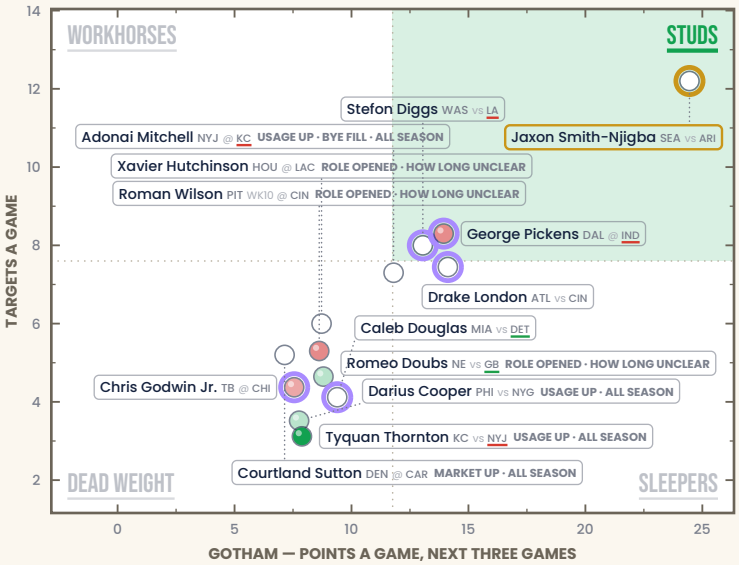



**Floor:** 6.0 a game — 85% of Kaelon Black, the weakest starter here (7.1).

**Doors:** Justice Hill — workload 7.8->20.8

## RECEIVERS

AS OF **WED NOV. 4, 1:13 PM**

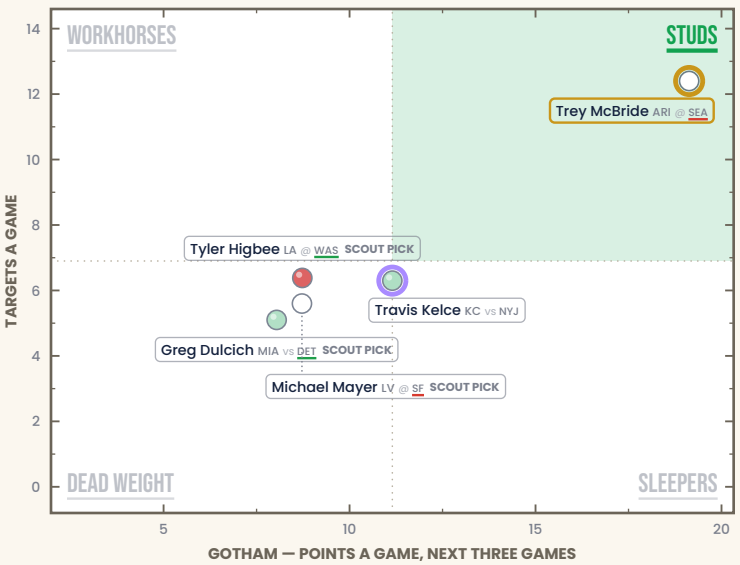



**Floor:** 6.4 a game — 85% of Chris Godwin Jr., the weakest starter here (7.5).

**Doors:** Adonai Mitchell — workload 6.5->9.7; covers Wk11 Drake London, Wk10 Chris Godwin Jr.; Romeo Doubs — teammate down this week: Mack Hollins Out; Xavier Hutchinson — teammate down this week: Jaylin Noel Out; Roman Wilson — teammate out: Michael…

## TIGHT ENDS

AS OF **WED NOV. 4, 1:13 PM**




**Floor:** 9.5 a game — 85% of Travis Kelce, the weakest starter here (11.2).

**Doors:** Greg Dulcich — Scout pick; Tyler Higbee — Scout pick; Michael Mayer — Scout pick

**Legend:** rising (pale = a little, deep = a lot) · falling (pink = a little, red = a lot) · new — no games yet · flat
violet ring = on this roster · gold ring = best at the position · BYE FILL / INJURY FILL = covers a bye or an injury on this roster
Movement = his last two games, the latest counting most, against his own earlier average. · SCOUT PICK = recommended on the Scout page
vs = home, @ = away (this week's opponent). Line under him: ___ hard ___ easy against this man's position; none = middle. Thursday's teams show next week's game.
Plate words: USAGE UP = workload jumped · ROLE OPENED = a teammate ahead of him is out (MAY OPEN = unconfirmed) · MARKET UP = sources well above Gotham
Marks beside a plate: drop order — red first, then gold, then grey · news this week — Radar page · D drift moved his workload · on the Call Sheet

**How to read it:** Across = points going forward. Up = how much his team uses him. Lines = the middle of the rostered field. Studs = ahead on both.

## SCORECARD

UPCOMING

**UNDERDOG** 156.3 to 172.1

Hector Football · 3–5, 10th of 12

Yahoo's projection for both lineups

| | |
|---|---|
| DK II | 156.3 |
| Opp | 172.1 |

Projected margin -15.7 · Yahoo, lineups as set

| FTN | YAHOO | GOTHAM |
|---|---|---|
| 44% | 39% | 34% |

Win chance before kickoff — Yahoo center, FTN left, Gotham right

| | |
|---|---|
| **Players** | Tagged: Montgomery (O), Kelce (Q) |
| **Record** | 4–4 entering Week 9 |
| **Standing** | 7th of 12 entering the week · 12th in points |

1 2 3 4 5 6 **7** 8 9 10 11 12

Playoff spots | Playoff line

## OUTLOOK

WEEK 9

DK II goes in as the underdog. Yahoo projects 156.3 to 172.1 against Hector Football (3–5, 10th of 12), a 15.7-point gap. Win chance: Yahoo 39%, FTN 44%, Gotham 34%. The engines split by 10: Yahoo uses the lineups as set, FTN and Gotham the best ones. At 4–4, 7th of 12: 1 spot below the playoff line, so this week counts.

**Before kickoff.** Montgomery is O; Kelce is Q. FTN and Gotham both would start Allen over Montgomery (+12.5). The best lineup closes about 12.5 of the 15.7-point gap, so the rest has to come from the starters beating their projections - check the Scout for an add that lifts this week.

**Where it's won and lost.** Theirs: D. Swift over Montgomery at RB (-21.0); P. Nacua over London at WR (-6.1). Gotham is cooler than Yahoo on Price (9.1 vs 14.0) and McConkey (7.8 vs 12.4) - his workload doesn't support Yahoo's number, so lean on him less.

Week 9, looking ahead — Yahoo read Wed Nov. 4, 1:36 PM PT

## STARTERS

Lineup as set on Yahoo · Week 9

| PLAYER | MARKERS | POS | TEAM | SLOT | VS | BYE | PROJECTED BEFORE KICKOFF YAHOO | FTN | GOTHAM | SCORE | NEXT 3 | AVG | OPPONENT | SCORE | DELTA |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| J.J. McCarthy | alert | QB | NYG | QB | @ PHI | 8 | 16.6 | 18.9 | 17.5 | — | — | 10.0 | B. Young | 19.8 | |
| David Montgomery | INJ O · alert · news3 · ↓ | RB | HOU | RB | @ LAC | 8 | 0.0 | 6.0 | 0.0 | — | 11.4 | 11.7 | D. Swift | 21.0 | |
| Jadarian Price | alert · news1 | RB | SEA | RB | vs ARI | 11 | 14.0 | 10.8 | 9.1 | — | 8.9 | 7.3 | B. Hall | 13.4 | |
| Drake London | news2 | WR | ATL | WR | vs CIN | 11 | 18.2 | 15.1 | 14.6 | — | 14.1 | 13.8 | P. Nacua | 24.3 | |
| Ja'Marr Chase | news4 · ↑ | WR | CIN | WR | @ ATL | 6 | 20.8 | 19.8 | 20.2 | — | 19.3 | 18.3 | C. Lamb | 20.4 | |
| Ladd McConkey | news1 | WR | LAC | WR | vs HOU | 7 | 12.4 | 11.6 | 7.8 | — | 8.4 | 8.6 | A.J. Brown | 11.2 | |
| Travis Kelce | INJ Q · news2 · ↑ | TE | KC | TE | vs NYJ | 5 | 12.3 | 10.2 | 12.2 | — | 11.2 | 11.7 | T. Kraft | 11.7 | |
| Alvin Kamara | alert · ↑ | RB | NO | FLEX | vs CLE | 8 | 12.2 | 11.4 | 11.8 | — | 12.5 | 12.7 | R. White | 14.1 | |
| Jayden Daniels | news3 | QB | WAS | SFLEX | vs LA | 7 | 22.3 | 21.3 | 19.9 | — | 21.4 | 23.9 | K. Murray | 21.7 | |
| Will Reichard | scout03 | K | MIN | K | vs BUF | 6 | 8.4 | 11.4 | — | — | — | — | C. Santos | 8.4 | |
| Chiefs | alert · scout00 | DEF | KC | DEF | vs NYJ | 5 | 7.7 | 9.2 | — | — | — | — | DAL D | 5.8 | |
| **TOTAL** | | | | | | | **144.9** | | | | | | | 172.1 | |

## BENCH

Yahoo projects only the lineup

| PLAYER | MARKERS | POS | TEAM | SLOT | VS | BYE | PROJECTED BEFORE KICKOFF YAHOO | FTN | GOTHAM | SCORE | NEXT 3 | AVG | VALUE |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Braelon Allen | alert · news1 · scout24 · D | RB | NYJ | BN | @ KC | 13 | — | 14.1 | 13.5 | — | 17.1 | 16.0 | Covers Price's Wk 11 bye |
| Germie Bernard | alert · news2 · ↓ | WR | PIT | BN | BYE | 9 | — | — | — | — | 11.4 | 9.6 | On bye · back Wk 10 |
| Aaron Rodgers | news1 · ↓ | QB | PIT | BN | BYE | 9 | — | — | — | — | 18.8 | 18.3 | On bye · back Wk 10 |
| Kyle Pitts Sr. | news2 · ↑ | TE | ATL | BN | vs CIN | 11 | — | 9.6 | 9.0 | — | 8.8 | 8.2 | Depth at TE · 8.8 next 3 |
| Buccaneers | scout00 | WR | | BN | BYE | 1 | — | — | — | — | — | — | On bye · back Wk 10 |

## IR

1 of 2 slots used

| PLAYER | MARKERS | POS | TEAM | SLOT | VS | BYE | PROJECTED BEFORE KICKOFF YAHOO | FTN | GOTHAM | SCORE | NEXT 3 | AVG | VALUE |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Travis Etienne Jr. | INJ IR · alert · news1 · ↓ | RB | NO | IR | vs CLE | 8 | — | — | 0.0 | — | 13.6 | 12.8 | On IR · holds no roster seat |
| OPEN | | | | IR | | | | | | | | | Open IR slot |

**F** final **INJ** Yahoo tag **Score** green beat Yahoo by 3+, red 4+ short **Band** playing now **Markers** alert news2 scout03 Scout need **D** drift ↑ playing time

**The Scout** is the engine built to find this team's needs: every hole and thin spot, week by week through the playoffs, ranked by what each one costs in wins, with what is needed, when, and who available could fill it. Everything here is a recommendation to talk through. A move becomes an action only once it is decided, and then it goes to the Call Sheet.

**Open Seats** — 1 IR slot open (only for a player Yahoo lists as IR or Out)

**If Travis Kelce Sits** — Questionable, starting at TE (~10.2 this week). The bench covers it: the best lineup without him is only ~0.6 pts lower. If Yahoo lists him Out, the open IR slot can hold him and the add costs no drop.

**Missing Pieces** **A lead running back** - Braelon Allen drops to about 9 a game once Breece Hall is back; Etienne (IR, earliest Week 9) and Montgomery are the hope, neither confirmed · **A wide receiver for Week 10 on** - Germie Bernard's role shrinks when Michael Pittman returns; McConkey (claimed Oct 25) is the bet if he clears his concussion

**Expert Moves** (read Mon Nov 2 2026 8:58 PM PT) Up: Braelon Allen RB 18 RB 9 · Down: Aaron Rodgers QB 15 QB 24

## Gate 1 · Needs, in Priority Order

Each slot named on this roster · the target is what the slot will give · measured against the opponent's man that week

### The Backfield Won't Hold — RB1, Season-Long · Target 8.0 pts 24

Drops Off When Filled

Replacing a ~21: Braelon Allen becomes ~8 once Breece Hall is back (missed his last game (Quadricep), practicing this week (no report)). Worst weeks: Wk 13 Etienne ~12.3, Wk 17 Allen ~13.3.

**Kaelon Black**, SF RB · Scored 11.5, 4.2, 2.7, 2.8, 3.1, 6.7, 13.9 · Free Agent · Door open: Isaac Guerendo out; workload up from 6.4 to 14.4 expected a game; news (RotoBaller, Nov 2): Who Should I Pickup for Fantasy Football Week 9? Tyler Allgeier, Jordyn Tyson, Kenny Gainwell, Khalil Shakir, Emmett Johnson, Mike Washington Jr., Seth McGowan, Kaelon Black; CHECK FIRST: his work depends on Isaac Guerendo staying out - check Guerendo's status first; RATCLIFFE HIGHER (Ratcliffe 11.2 a week vs engine 7.6); Koerner 9.4 vs Ratcliffe 10.2 this week - experts agree; helps Wk 15. · **Adds ~2 pts through Wk 17** (2 in the playoffs) · **This week vs your FLEX Jadarian Price: Ratcliffe 10.2 vs 10.8 · Koerner 9.4 vs 14.9 · Yahoo 8.1 vs 14.0 · Gotham 7.9 vs 9.1 - WORSE this week** · **Fills a missing piece**

### The Defense Won't Hold — DEF, Season-Long · Target 9.1 pts

Drops Off When Filled

Full strength ~13.6 (Buccaneers). Wk 9 Chiefs ~9.2 (Buccaneers has a worse matchup) · Wk 10 Chiefs ~5.4 (Buccaneers on bye, Chiefs slides in) · Wk 11 Buccaneers ~7.3 (hard matchup vs DET) · Wk 12 Buccaneers ~10.2 · Wk 14 Buccaneers ~10.1 · Wk 15 Buccaneers ~10.3 · Wk 16 Buccaneers ~11.3 · Wk 17 Buccaneers ~8.9.

**GB DEF** · Scored 1, 5, -2, 8, 18, 9, 6, 11 · Free Agent · Current level ~7.5 a game; RATCLIFFE HIGHER (Ratcliffe 7.3 a week vs engine 5.6); Koerner 6.9 vs Ratcliffe 7.3 this week - experts agree; helps Wk 10. · **Adds ~1 pts through Wk 17** · **This week vs your DEF Chiefs DEF: Ratcliffe 7.3 vs 9.2 · Koerner 6.9 vs 8.0 · Yahoo 5.5 vs 7.7 - WORSE this week**

**CIN DEF** · Scored 18, 11, 5, 4, 9, 10, 4 · Waivers, Clears Nov 7 · Current level ~7.4 a game; rival check: 8 teams would start him over one of their own - Diddys Booty Butter ($50 left, waiver #3), RFFR ($100 left, waiver #7), FUCKING COWBOYS ($95 left, waiver #4), Trophy Hunter ($69 left, waiver #8), RAIDER FAN ($82 left, waiver #1), Rams house ($100 left, waiver #2); BOTH AGREE (Ratcliffe 7.5, engine 6.0 a week); Koerner 5.4 vs Ratcliffe 7.5 this week - experts agree; helps Wk 10. · **Adds ~1 pts through Wk 17** · **This week vs your DEF Chiefs DEF: Ratcliffe 7.5 vs 9.2 · Koerner 5.4 vs 8.0 · Yahoo 5.8 vs 7.7 - WORSE this week**

### Tough Draws for the Kicker Spot — K, Weeks 10, 15 Fill · Target 8.6 pts 03/10

Drops Off After Wk 15

Full strength ~11.1 (Reichard). Wk 10 Reichard ~8.6 (hard matchup vs GB) · Wk 15 Reichard ~8.7 (hard matchup vs DET).

**Chase McLaughlin**, TB K · Scored 11, 16, 12, 2, 7, 17, 12, 12 · Free Agent · Current level ~11.8 a game; news: nothing on him in 14 days (RotoWire, ESPN, PFT, RotoBaller); RATCLIFFE HIGHER (Ratcliffe 11.0 a week vs engine 7.8); Koerner 7.5 vs Ratcliffe 11.0 this week - THE EXPERTS SPLIT, check why; helps Wk 15. · **Adds ~3 pts through Wk 17** (3 in the playoffs) · **This week vs your K Will Reichard: Ratcliffe 11.0 vs 11.4 · Koerner 7.5 vs 7.8 · Yahoo 7.7 vs 8.4 - WORSE this week**

**Also on the Board** RB2, Weeks 12, 14-15 Fill | WR3, Week 11 Fill | WR2, Week 11 Fill

## Gate 2 · Available, Could Incrementally Improve the Team

Found by workload, an opening, or a return · priced as if a seat opens · no drops suggested

None this run.

## Gate 3 · Hunches

Written down, aged and graded like any other name

None written yet.

**Checked, Not Assumed** Allen ~20.6 to ~8.0 from Wk 9 — Breece Hall checked: rostered by Hector Football · Can't claim: Jacoby Brissett (ARI QB) - you dropped him, and Yahoo blocks claiming back your own drop while he's on waivers. If nobody claims him he's a free agent after Nov 7 and you can add him then. · Can't claim: CLE defense (CLE DEF) - you dropped him, and Yahoo blocks claiming back your own drop while he's on waivers. If nobody claims him he's a free agent after Nov 7 and you can add him then. · Stash: Kaelon Black (SF RB, free agent) - 35% of the SF backfield's touches the last three games behind Christian McCaffrey (~25.1 a game, 63%); the lead job is his if McCaffrey goes down; his own level now ~8.3 · Stash: Kenny Gainwell (TB RB, free agent) - 34% of the TB backfield's touches the last three games behind Bucky Irving (~22.4 a game, 60%); the lead job is his if Irving goes down; his own level now ~11.1 · Rising: Gunnar Helm (TEN TE, free agent) - workload jumped to 13.4 expected points last game from 4.0 before; season level ~5.5, not on the Scout's pickup list yet - one more game like it and he is · Rising: Jordan Watkins (SF WR, free agent) - workload jumped to 10.0 expected points last game from 1.2 before; season level ~3.1, not on the Scout's pickup list yet - one more game like it and he is · Antonio Williams (WAS WR) is on the Positions chart (teammate down this week: Terry McLaurin Out): adds nothing to the best lineup through Wk 17, real level ~8.2 a game; ranks below the picks above · Caleb Douglas (MIA WR) is on the Positions chart (workload 4.8->6.0): adds nothing to the best lineup through Wk 17, real level ~8.6 a game; ranks below the picks above · Jahan Dotson (ATL WR) is on the Positions chart (teammate down this week: Zachariah Branch Out): adds nothing to the best lineup through Wk 17, real level ~7.0 a game; ranks below the picks above · Kendre Miller (NO RB) is on the Positions chart (teammate out: Travis Etienne): adds nothing to the best lineup through Wk 17, real level ~12.1 a game; ranks below the picks above

Protected (Dom's call): Travis Kelce · Rosters Yahoo Wed Nov 4, 1:36 PM PT (API) · Stats nflverse Wed 1:36 PM PT

# DARK KNIGHT DISPATCH

## POSITIONS • DK II

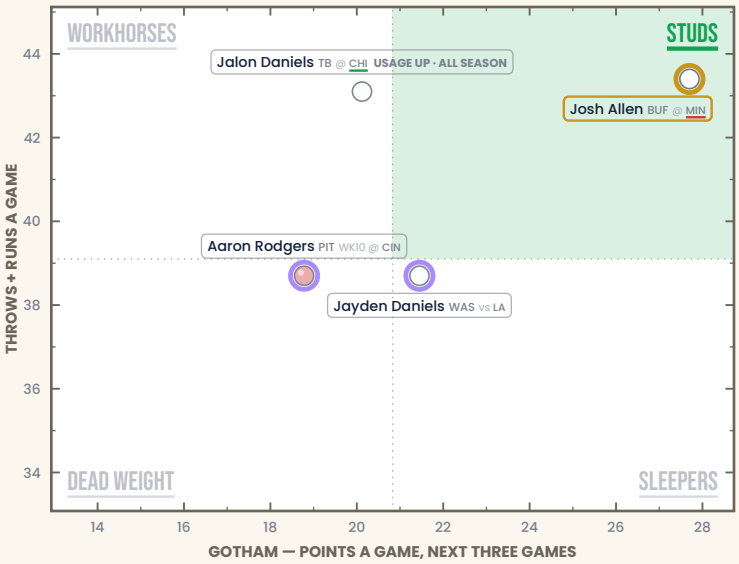
Week 9 · Roles, and the free agents worth a look

Data · Wed Nov. 4, 1:36 PM PT



## QUARTERBACKS

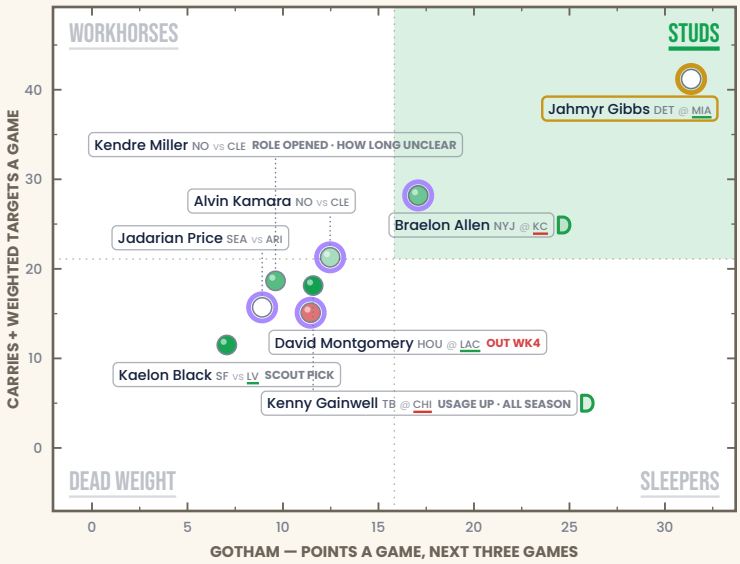
AS OF **WED NOV. 4, 1:13 PM**




**Floor:** 18.2 a game — 85% of Jayden Daniels, the weakest starter here (21.4).
**Doors:** Jalon Daniels — workload 39.5->50.2

## RUNNING BACKS

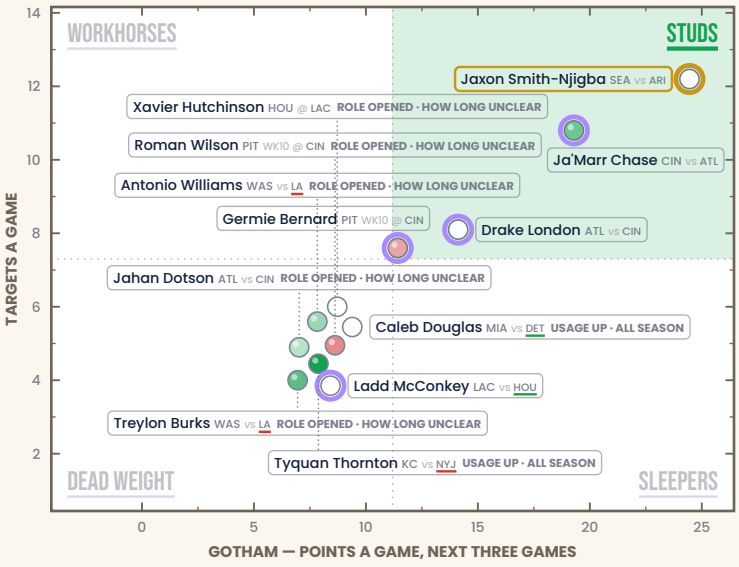
AS OF **WED NOV. 4, 1:13 PM**




**Floor:** 7.6 a game — 85% of Jadarian Price, the weakest starter here (8.9).
**Doors:** Kenny Gainwell — workload 10.3->26.9; Kendre Miller — teammate out: Travis Etienne; Kaelon Black — Scout pick — adds ~2 pts through Wk 17

## RECEIVERS

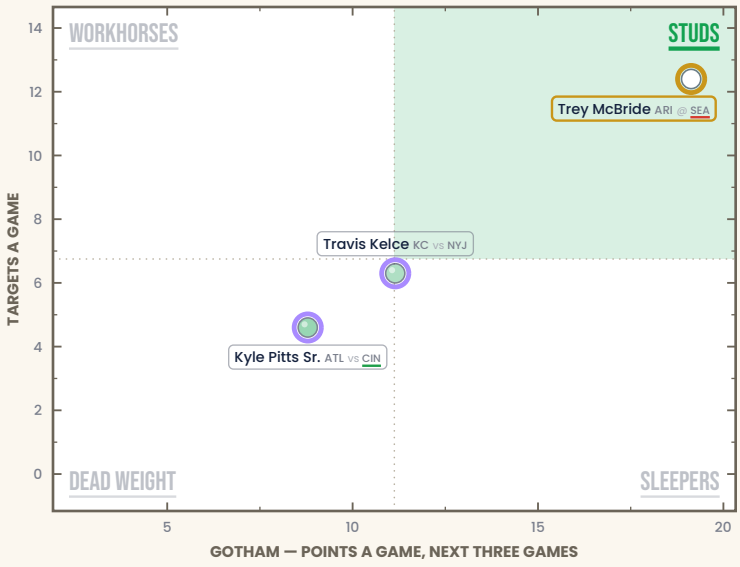
AS OF **WED NOV. 4, 1:13 PM**




**Floor:** 7.2 a game — 85% of Ladd McConkey, the weakest starter here (8.4).
**Doors:** Caleb Douglas — workload 4.8->6.0; Xavier Hutchinson — teammate down this week: Jaylin Noel Out; Roman Wilson — teammate out: Michael Pittman Jr.; Tyquan Thornton — workload 2.3->9.4

## TIGHT ENDS

AS OF **WED NOV. 4, 1:13 PM**




**Floor:** 9.5 a game — 85% of Travis Kelce, the weakest starter here (11.2).
**Doors:** no free agent clears the floor through any door. Closest: Michael Mayer LV 8.7, Mason Taylor NYJ 8.2.

**Legend:** rising (pale = a little, deep = a lot) · falling (pink = a little, red = a lot) · new — no games yet · flat · violet ring = on this roster · gold ring = best at the position · BYE FILL / INJURY FILL = covers a bye or an injury on this roster

Movement = his last two games, the latest counting most, against his own earlier average. SCOUT PICK = recommended on the Scout page

vs = home, @ = away (this week's opponent). Line under him: ___ hard ___ easy against this man's position; none = middle. Thursday's teams show next week's game.

Plate words: USAGE UP = workload jumped · ROLE OPENED = a teammate ahead of him is out (MAY OPEN = unconfirmed) · MARKET UP = sources well above Gotham

Marks beside a plate: drop order — red first, then gold, then grey · news this week — Radar page · D drift moved his workload · 1 on the Call Sheet

**How to read it:** Across = points going forward. Up = how much his team uses him. Lines = the middle of the rostered field. Studs = ahead on both.

## SCORECARD

UPCOMING

**TOSS-UP** 123.2 to 127.6

Maly's Better Half · 3–5, 9th of 14

Yahoo's projection for both lineups

| | |
|---|---|
| DK III | 123.2 |
| Opp | 127.6 |

Projected margin -4.4 · Yahoo, lineups as set



44% FTN · 46% YAHOO · 42% GOTHAM

Win chance before kickoff — Yahoo center, FTN left, Gotham right

| | |
|---|---|
| **Players** | Tagged: Montgomery (O) |
| **Record** | 3–5 entering Week 9 |
| **Standing** | 13th of 14 entering the week · 13th in points |

1 2 3 4 5 6 | 7 8 9 10 11 12 **13** 14

Playoff spots | Playoff line

## OUTLOOK

WEEK 9

DK III goes in in a toss-up. Yahoo projects 123.2 to 127.6 against Maly's Better Half (3–5, 9th of 14), a 4.4-point gap. Win chance: Yahoo 46%, FTN 44%, Gotham 42%. The three engines agree. At 3–5, 13th of 14: 7 spots below the playoff line, so this week counts.

**Before kickoff.** Montgomery is O. Gotham would start Downs over Montgomery (+9.5); FTN would start Douglas over Montgomery (+4.3). Making those moves roughly closes the gap.

**Where it's won and lost.** Your edges: Hockenson over A. Barner at TE (+3.6). Theirs: J. Price over Montgomery at FLEX (-13.9); J. Cook III over Fannin at FLEX (-7.9).

Week 9, looking ahead — Yahoo read Wed Nov. 4, 1:36 PM PT

## STARTERS

Lineup as set on Yahoo · Week 9

| PLAYER | MARKERS | POS | TEAM | SLOT | VS | BYE | PROJECTED BEFORE KICKOFF YAHOO | FTN | GOTHAM | SCORE | NEXT 3 | AVG | OPPONENT | SCORE | DELTA |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Jayden Daniels | 3 | QB | WAS | QB | vs LA | 7 | 22.3 | 21.3 | 19.9 | — | 21.4 | 23.9 | J. Goff | 23.1 | |
| Rachaad White | 1 ↑ | RB | WAS | RB | vs LA | 7 | 14.0 | 12.2 | 12.4 | — | 12.1 | 12.4 | A. Jeanty | 14.4 | |
| Jonah Coleman | 2 D ↑ | RB | DEN | RB | @ CAR | 10 | 17.3 | 16.6 | 17.2 | — | 16.3 | 12.9 | O. Gordo… | 16.8 | |
| George Pickens | 1 Q26 ↓ | WR | DAL | WR | @ IND | 14 | 14.2 | 13.4 | 13.8 | — | 13.9 | 13.0 | P. Washi… | 14.7 | |
| Jaylen Waddle | 5 | WR | DEN | WR | @ CAR | 10 | 12.4 | 11.1 | 10.8 | — | 10.7 | 9.9 | J. Williams | 12.1 | |
| T.J. Hockenson | 2 Q26 ↓ | TE | MIN | TE | vs BUF | 6 | 11.3 | 10.5 | 9.8 | — | 11.1 | 11.2 | A. Barner | 7.8 | |
| Harold Fannin Jr. | 2 Q26 D ↑ | TE | CLE | FLEX | @ NO | 11 | 11.5 | 11.2 | 11.5 | — | 14.1 | 11.3 | J. Cook III | 19.4 | |
| David Montgomery INJ O | 3 Q07 ↓ | RB | HOU | FLEX | @ LAC | 8 | 0.0 | 6.0 | 0.0 | — | 11.4 | 11.7 | J. Price | 13.9 | |
| Giants | Q03 | DEF | NYG | DEF | @ PHI | 8 | 8.8 | 10.5 | — | — | — | — | WAS D | 5.4 | |
| **TOTAL** | | | | | | | **111.9** | | | | | | | 127.6 | |

## BENCH

Yahoo projects only the lineup

| PLAYER | MARKERS | POS | TEAM | SLOT | VS | BYE | PROJECTED BEFORE KICKOFF YAHOO | FTN | GOTHAM | SCORE | NEXT 3 | AVG | VALUE |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Josh Downs | 1 Q26 ↓ | WR | IND | BN | vs DAL | 13 | — | 8.9 | 9.5 | — | 9.5 | 8.7 | Covers Waddle's Wk 10 bye |
| Aaron Rodgers | 1 ↓ | QB | PIT | BN | BYE | 9 | — | — | — | — | 18.8 | 18.3 | On bye · back Wk 10 |
| Caleb Douglas | 1 Q26 | WR | MIA | BN | vs DET | 6 | — | 10.3 | 8.6 | — | 9.4 | 11.9 | Covers Waddle's Wk 10 bye |
| Packers | Q03 | WR | | BN | BYE | 1 | — | — | — | — | — | — | On bye · back Wk 10 |
| Steelers | Q03 | WR | | BN | BYE | 1 | — | — | — | — | — | — | On bye · back Wk 10 |

## IR

1 of 1 slot used

| PLAYER | MARKERS | POS | TEAM | SLOT | VS | BYE | PROJECTED BEFORE KICKOFF YAHOO | FTN | GOTHAM | SCORE | NEXT 3 | AVG | VALUE |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Michael Pittman Jr. INJ IR | 3 | WR | PIT | IR | BYE | 9 | — | — | — | — | 6.1 | 5.3 | On IR · holds no roster seat |

**F** game final, SCORE is real. No F: still a projection.
**INJ** Yahoo's tag: Q questionable, D doubtful, O out, IR.
**Score** green = beat Yahoo's projection by 3+; red = 4+ short.
**Projected** each source before kickoff; Gotham skips K and DEF.

**Band** around a whole row: he is playing right now.
**Markers** 2 Radar news (count) · Q03 Scout need (days) · D role drift · ↑ playing time up / down
Red = act, gold = watch, green = good. Up to four per man, news first.

**The Scout** is the engine built to find this team's needs: every hole and thin spot, week by week through the playoffs, ranked by what each one costs in wins, with what is needed, when, and who available could fill it. Everything here is a recommendation to talk through. A move becomes an action only once it is decided, and then it goes to the Call Sheet.

**Missing Pieces** **A lead running back - save the $91 for him** - Every back is a fill-in: Bam Knight until Love returns, White until Croskey-Merritt does, Perine in a split, Montgomery hurt

**Expert Moves** (read Mon Nov 2 2026 8:58 PM PT) Up: Jonah Coleman RB 51 RB 22 · Up: Caleb Douglas WR 52 WR 45 · Up: George Pickens WR 19 WR 13 · Down: Josh Downs WR 30 WR 45 · Down: Jaylen Waddle WR 24 WR 33 · Down: Aaron Rodgers QB 15 QB 24

## Gate 1 · Needs, in Priority Order

Each slot named on this roster · the target is what the slot will give · measured against the opponent's man that week

### The Defense Won't Hold — DEF, Season-Long · Target 11.5 pts 03/7

Drops Off When Filled

Full strength ~15.9 (Steelers). Wk 9 Giants ~10.5 (Steelers on bye, Giants slides in) · Wk 10 Packers ~11.4 (Steelers has a worse matchup) · Wk 11 Steelers ~13.2 · Wk 12 Steelers ~9.8 (hard matchup vs DEN) · Wk 13 Steelers ~10.4 (hard matchup vs HOU) · Wk 14 Steelers ~9.2 (hard matchup vs JAX) · Wk 15 Steelers ~12.7 · Wk 16 Steelers ~12.8 · Wk 17 Steelers ~13.4.

No recommendation — nobody available fits.

### Byes Hit the Tight End Spot — TE, Weeks 9-11 Fill · Target 10.2 pts 26

Drops Off After Wk 11

Full strength ~13.2 (Fannin). Wk 9 Fannin ~11.2 · Wk 10 Fannin ~10.8 (hard matchup vs HOU) · Wk 11 Hockenson ~8.6 (Fannin on bye, Hockenson slides in).

▶ **Hunter Henry**, NE TE · Scored 5.6, 7.0, 1.5, 11.2, 13.4, 14.8, 14.1 · Waivers, Clears Nov 7 · Door open: Julian Hill out; workload up from 6.7 to 9.7 expected a game; NEWS FLAG - check before acting: (RotoBaller, Nov 1): Hunter Henry Ruled Out With Foot Injury Against Dolphins; CHECK FIRST: his work depends on Julian Hill staying out - check Hill's status first; rival check: 6 teams would start him over one of their own - Benchdad's Beach ($59 left, waiver #7), Maly's Better Half ($44 left, waiver #6), Bad and Bougie 2.0 ($100 left, waiver #10), Rushin Roulette ($51 left, waiver #9), Derek's Better Half ($100 left, waiver #11), Mrs. Bobo ($100 left, waiver #1); BOTH AGREE (Ratcliffe 7.5, engine 8.8 a week); Koerner 10.2 vs Ratcliffe 4.8 this week - THE EXPERTS SPLIT, check why; helps Wk 10. · **Adds ~3 pts through Wk 17** · **This week vs your FLEX2 Caleb Douglas: Ratcliffe 4.8 vs 10.3 · Koerner 10.2 vs 8.7 · Yahoo 8.9 vs 8.9 · Gotham 9.4 vs 8.6 - mixed - Ratcliffe says worse**

### The Flex Runs Thin — FLEX1, Week 10 Fill · Target 8.1 pts 26

Drops Off After Wk 10

Full strength ~11.1 (Hockenson). Wk 10 Douglas ~8.1 (Hockenson moves up to FLEX2, Douglas slides in).

▶ **Hunter Henry**, NE TE · Scored 5.6, 7.0, 1.5, 11.2, 13.4, 14.8, 14.1 · Waivers, Clears Nov 7 · Door open: Julian Hill out; workload up from 6.7 to 9.7 expected a game; NEWS FLAG - check before acting: (RotoBaller, Nov 1): Hunter Henry Ruled Out With Foot Injury Against Dolphins; CHECK FIRST: his work depends on Julian Hill staying out - check Hill's status first; rival check: 6 teams would start him over one of their own - Benchdad's Beach ($59 left, waiver #7), Maly's Better Half ($44 left, waiver #6), Bad and Bougie 2.0 ($100 left, waiver #10), Rushin Roulette ($51 left, waiver #9), Derek's Better Half ($100 left, waiver #11), Mrs. Bobo ($100 left, waiver #1); BOTH AGREE (Ratcliffe 7.5, engine 8.8 a week); Koerner 10.2 vs Ratcliffe 4.8 this week - THE EXPERTS SPLIT, check why; helps Wk 10. · **Adds ~3 pts through Wk 17** · **This week vs your FLEX2 Caleb Douglas: Ratcliffe 4.8 vs 10.3 · Koerner 10.2 vs 8.7 · Yahoo 8.9 vs 8.9 · Gotham 9.4 vs 8.6 - mixed - Ratcliffe says worse**

**Also on the Board** FLEX2, Week 10 Fill | RB1, Weeks 11-14 Fill | RB2, Weeks 10-12, 14 Fill | WR1, Weeks 10, 13-14 Fill | WR2, Weeks 10, 14 Fill

## Gate 2 · Available, Could Incrementally Improve the Team

Found by workload, an opening, or a return · priced as if a seat opens · no drops suggested

▶ **QB, Weeks 13, 15** · **Michael Penix Jr.**, ATL QB · Scored 16.5, 15.2, 16.9, 29.4, 27.7, -0.6 · Free Agent · Door open: Cooper Rush off the roster; door closing: Andy Dalton joined ATL from PHI: his pre-trade ~18.5 a game cut to ~17.8 (4% of the QB production goes to the newcomer); news (RotoBaller, Nov 4): Michael Penix Jr. a Deep-League Streaming Option in Week 9; BOTH AGREE (Ratcliffe 18.6, engine 16.0 a week); Koerner 18.4 vs Ratcliffe 19.7 this week - experts agree; helps Wk 13, Wk 15. · **Adds ~3 pts through Wk 17** (0 in the playoffs) · **This week vs your QB Jayden Daniels: Ratcliffe 19.7 vs 21.3 · Koerner 18.4 vs 19.9 · Yahoo 20.7 vs 22.3 · Gotham 17.5 vs 19.9 - WORSE this week**

## Gate 3 · Hunches

Written down, aged and graded like any other name

None written yet.

**Checked, Not Assumed** Stash: Chris Rodriguez Jr. (JAX RB, free agent) - 31% of the JAX backfield's touches the last three games behind Bhayshul Tuten (~19.9 a game, 56%); the lead job is his if Tuten goes down; his own level now ~8.6 · Stash: MarShawn Lloyd (GB RB, free agent) - 25% of the GB backfield's touches the last three games behind Josh Jacobs (~22.5 a game, 53%); the lead job is his if Jacobs goes down; his own level now ~7.7 · Rising: Gunnar Helm (TEN TE, free agent) - workload jumped to 13.4 expected points last game from 4.0 before; season level ~5.5, not on the Scout's pickup list yet - one more game like it and he is · Rising: Jordan Watkins (SF WR, free agent) - workload jumped to 10.0 expected points last game from 1.2 before; season level ~3.1, not on the Scout's pickup list yet - one more game like it and he is · Dalton Schultz (HOU TE) is on the Positions chart (covers Wk11 Harold Fannin Jr.): adds ~2 pts through Wk 17, real level ~9.1 a game; ranks below the picks above · AJ Dillon (CAR RB) is on the Positions chart (teammate down this week: Jonathon Brooks Out; covers Wk9 David Montgomery, Wk10 Jonah Coleman): adds nothing to the best lineup through Wk 17, real level ~3.9 a game; ranks below the picks above · Charlie Kolar (LAC TE) is on the Positions chart (teammate down this week: David Njoku Out; covers Wk11 Harold Fannin Jr.): adds nothing to the best lineup through Wk 17, real level ~5.4 a game; ranks below the picks above · Darnell Washington (PIT TE) is on the Positions chart (workload 3.9->5.7; covers Wk11 Harold Fannin Jr.): adds nothing to the best lineup through Wk 17, real level ~7.2 a game; ranks below the picks above

Protected: none · Rosters Yahoo Wed Nov 4, 1:36 PM PT (API) · Stats nflverse Wed 1:36 PM PT

# DARK KNIGHT DISPATCH

## POSITIONS • DK III

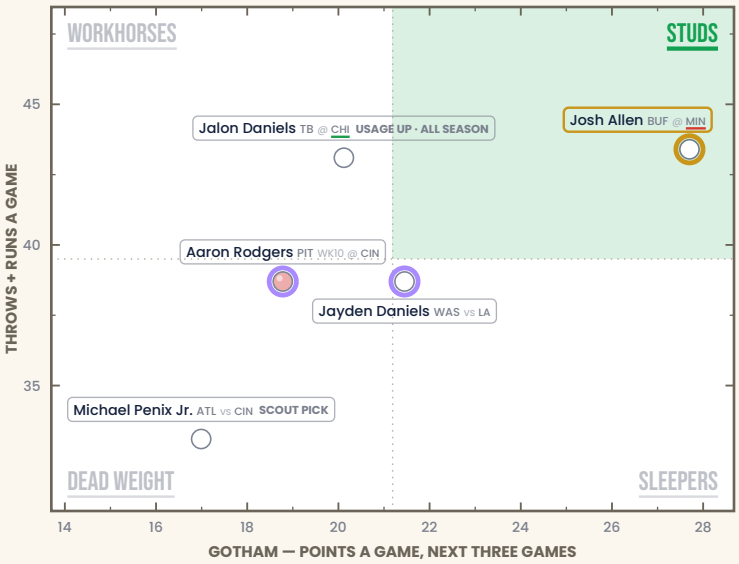
Week 9 · Roles, and the free agents worth a look

Data · Wed Nov. 4, 1:36 PM PT



## QUARTERBACKS

AS OF **WED NOV. 4, 1:13 PM**

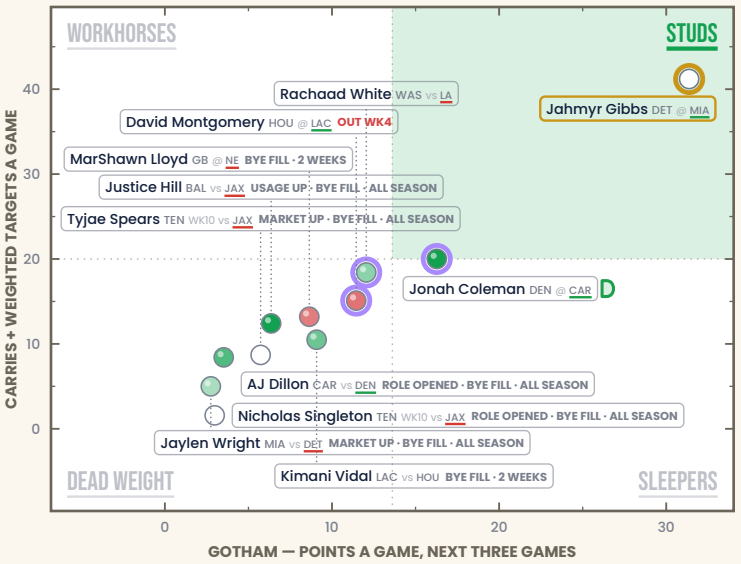



**Floor:** 18.2 a game — 85% of Jayden Daniels, the weakest starter here (21.4).

**Doors:** Jalon Daniels — workload 39.5->50.2; Michael Penix Jr. — Scout pick — adds ~3 pts through Wk 17

## RUNNING BACKS

AS OF **WED NOV. 4, 1:13 PM**



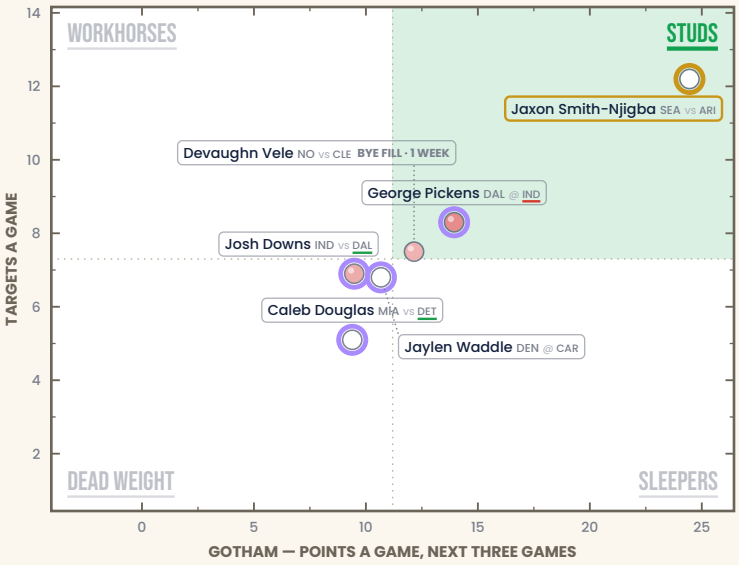

**Floor:** 9.7 a game — 85% of David Montgomery, the weakest starter here (11.4).

**Doors:** Justice Hill — workload 7.8->20.8; covers Wk9 David Montgomery, Wk10 Jonah Coleman; Tyjae Spears — covers Wk10 Jonah Coleman; AJ Dillon — teammate down this week: Jonathon Brooks Out; covers Wk9 David Montgomery, Wk10 Jonah Coleman; Nicholas…

**Check:** Sleeper far lower than Gotham — Tyjae Spears 5.7 vs 9.7, Jaylen Wright 2.8 vs 8.5. Look…

## RECEIVERS

AS OF **WED NOV. 4, 1:13 PM**

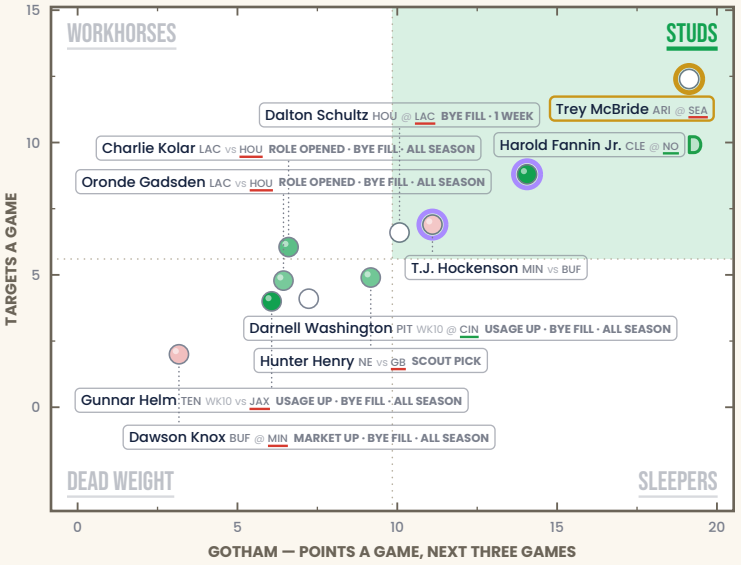



**Floor:** 9.1 a game — 85% of Jaylen Waddle, the weakest starter here (10.7).

**Doors:** Devaughn Vele — covers Wk10 Jaylen Waddle

## TIGHT ENDS

AS OF **WED NOV. 4, 1:13 PM**




**Floor:** 9.4 a game — 85% of T.J. Hockenson, the weakest starter here (11.1).

**Doors:** Dalton Schultz — covers Wk11 Harold Fannin Jr.; Darnell Washington — workload 3.9->5.7; covers Wk11 Harold Fannin Jr.; Charlie Kolar — teammate down this week: David Njoku Out; covers Wk11 Harold Fannin Jr.; Oronde Gadsden — teammate down this week: David Njoku…

**Legend:** rising (pale = a little, deep = a lot) · falling (pink = a little, red = a lot) · new — no games yet · flat · violet ring = on this roster · gold ring = best at the position · BYE FILL / INJURY FILL = covers a bye or an injury on this roster

Movement = his last two games, the latest counting most, against his own earlier average. SCOUT PICK = recommended on the Scout page

vs = home, @ = away (this week's opponent). Line under him: ___ hard ___ easy against this man's position; none = middle. Thursday's teams show next week's game.

Plate words: USAGE UP = workload jumped · ROLE OPENED = a teammate ahead of him is out (MAY OPEN = unconfirmed) · MARKET UP = sources well above Gotham

Marks beside a plate: drop order — red first, then gold, then grey · news this week — Radar page · D drift moved his workload · 1 on the Call Sheet

**How to read it:** Across = points going forward. Up = how much his team uses him. Lines = the middle of the rostered field. Studs = ahead on both.

## SCORECARD

UPCOMING

**TOSS-UP** 167.5 to 172.5

Alan's Team · 8–8, 4th of 10

Yahoo's projection for both lineups

| | |
|---|---|
| DK IV | 167.5 |
| Opp | 172.5 |

Projected margin -4.9 · Yahoo, lineups as set

| FTN | YAHOO | GOTHAM |
|---|---|---|
| 47% | 46% | 44% |

Win chance before kickoff — Yahoo center, FTN left, Gotham right

| | |
|---|---|
| **Players** | Tagged: Kelce (Q) |
| **Record** | 8–8 entering Week 9 · median game too |
| **Standing** | 6th of 10 entering the week · 7th in points |

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

Playoff spots | Playoff line

## OUTLOOK

WEEK 9

DK IV goes in in a toss-up. Yahoo projects 167.5 to 172.5 against Alan's Team (8–8, 4th of 10), a 4.9-point gap. Win chance: Yahoo 46%, FTN 47%, Gotham 44%. The three engines agree. At 8–8, 6th of 10: on the playoff line, with no room to give back.

**Before kickoff.** Kelce is Q. FTN would start Cooper over Meyers (+0.9). The best lineup closes about 0.9 of the 4.9-point gap, so the rest has to come from the starters beating their projections - check the Scout for an add that lifts this week.

**Where it's won and lost.** Your edges: Jefferson over D. Moore at WR (+5.9); Robinson over J. Taylor at RB (+4.9). Theirs: M. Nabers over Meyers at WR (-8.8); J. Chase over Flowers at WR (-6.1). Gotham is cooler than Yahoo on Jefferson (12.8 vs 17.9) and Flowers (10.0 vs 14.5) - his workload doesn't support Yahoo's number, so lean on him less.

Week 9, looking ahead — Yahoo read Wed Nov. 4, 1:36 PM PT

## STARTERS

Lineup as set on Yahoo · Week 9

| PLAYER | MARKERS | POS | TEAM | SLOT | VS | BYE | PROJECTED BEFORE KICKOFF YAHOO | FTN | GOTHAM | SCORE | NEXT 3 | AVG | OPPONENT | SCORE | DELTA |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Dak Prescott | 1 Q26 ↓ | QB | DAL | QB | @ IND | 14 | 24.6 | 22.7 | 23.8 | — | 22.5 | 22.6 | J. Love | 21.0 | |
| Bijan Robinson | 1 ↓ | RB | ATL | RB | vs CIN | 11 | 22.2 | 21.1 | 20.1 | — | 19.5 | 19.2 | J. Taylor | 17.3 | |
| D'Andre Swift | 1 D ↑ | RB | CHI | RB | vs TB | 10 | 16.6 | 15.3 | 16.5 | — | 19.2 | 18.8 | K. Walker… | 21.8 | |
| Zay Flowers | 2 ↓ | WR | BAL | WR | vs JAX | 13 | 14.5 | 12.5 | 10.0 | — | 15.6 | 17.5 | J. Chase | 20.6 | |
| Justin Jefferson | 1 Q05 | WR | MIN | WR | vs BUF | 6 | 17.9 | 14.3 | 12.8 | — | 14.3 | 14.4 | D. Moore | 12.0 | |
| Jakobi Meyers | 2 Q02 ↑ | WR | JAX | WR | @ BAL | 7 | 9.4 | 8.8 | 9.4 | — | 9.2 | 9.3 | M. Nabers | 18.2 | |
| Travis Kelce INJ Q | 2 Q07 ↑ | TE | KC | TE | vs NYJ | 5 | 12.2 | 10.2 | 12.2 | — | 11.1 | 11.7 | T.J. Hock… | 11.3 | |
| Ollie Gordon II | 2 Q26 | RB | MIA | FLEX | vs DET | 6 | 12.9 | 11.6 | 12.9 | — | 14.3 | 12.0 | I. Likely | 13.9 | |
| Jared Goff | 1 ↓ | QB | DET | SFLEX | @ MIA | 6 | 23.1 | 23.2 | 23.4 | — | 22.6 | 24.7 | B. Nix | 19.5 | |
| Will Reichard | Q03 | K | MIN | K | vs BUF | 6 | 8.4 | 11.4 | — | — | — | — | T. Bass | 8.5 | |
| Bengals | Q00 | DEF | CIN | DEF | @ ATL | 6 | 5.8 | 7.5 | — | — | — | — | DET D | 7.3 | |
| TOTAL | | | | | | | 167.5 | | | | | | | 172.5 | |

## BENCH

Yahoo projects only the lineup

| PLAYER | MARKERS | POS | TEAM | SLOT | VS | BYE | PROJECTED BEFORE KICKOFF YAHOO | FTN | GOTHAM | SCORE | NEXT 3 | AVG | VALUE |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Omar Cooper Jr. | 4 ↓ | WR | NYJ | BN | @ KC | 13 | — | 9.7 | 11.9 | — | 15.4 | 16.3 | Depth at WR · 15.4 next 3 |
| Wan'Dale Robinson | 1 Q02 ↑ | WR | TEN | BN | BYE | 9 | — | — | — | — | 11.0 | 9.7 | On bye · back Wk 10 |
| Tucker Kraft | 1 Q07 | TE | GB | BN | @ NE | 11 | — | 10.3 | 11.1 | — | 11.9 | 11.1 | Depth at TE · 11.9 next 3 |
| C.J. Stroud | 1 ↓ | QB | HOU | BN | @ LAC | 8 | — | 19.7 | 20.4 | — | 20.6 | 21.7 | Superflex depth at QB |
| Buccaneers | Q00 | WR | | BN | BYE | 1 | — | — | — | — | — | — | On bye · back Wk 10 |

## IR

2 of 3 slots used

| PLAYER | MARKERS | POS | TEAM | SLOT | VS | BYE | PROJECTED BEFORE KICKOFF YAHOO | FTN | GOTHAM | SCORE | NEXT 3 | AVG | VALUE |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| James Conner INJ IR | 1 | RB | ARI | IR | @ SEA | 14 | — | — | — | — | — | — | On IR · holds no roster seat |
| Isiah Pacheco INJ IR | 3 | RB | DET | IR | @ MIA | 6 | — | — | — | — | — | — | On IR · holds no roster seat |
| OPEN | | | | IR | | | | | | | | | Open IR slot |

**F** final **INJ** Yahoo tag **Score** green beat Yahoo by 3+, red 4+ short **Band** playing now **Markers** alert 2 news Q03 Scout need **D** drift ↑ playing time

**The Scout** is the engine built to find this team's needs: every hole and thin spot, week by week through the playoffs, ranked by what each one costs in wins, with what is needed, when, and who available could fill it. Everything here is a recommendation to talk through. A move becomes an action only once it is decided, and then it goes to the Call Sheet.

**Open Seats** — 1 IR slot open (only for a player Yahoo lists as IR or Out)

**If Travis Kelce Sits** — Questionable, starting at TE (~10.2 this week). The Scout's best lineup already starts someone else over him this week, so sitting him costs nothing.

**Missing Pieces** **A steady second wide receiver** - Jefferson dips once Jordan Addison is back, Downs fades when Alec Pierce returns, and Flowers is off in Week 13
**Expert Moves** (read Mon Nov 2 2026 8:58 PM PT) Up: Wan'Dale Robinson WR 36  WR 20 · Up: Omar Cooper Jr. WR 43  WR 34 · Up: Dak Prescott QB 9  QB 3 · Down: Jared Goff QB 5  QB 12

## Gate 1 · Needs, in Priority Order

Each slot named on this roster · the target is what the slot will give · measured against the opponent's man that week

### The Defense Won't Hold — DEF, Season-Long · Target 9.1 pts 01/11

Drops Off When Filled

Full strength ~13.6 (Buccaneers). Wk 9 Bengals ~7.5 (Buccaneers has a worse matchup) · Wk 10 Bengals ~7.3 (Buccaneers on bye, Bengals slides in) · Wk 11 Buccaneers ~7.3 (hard matchup vs DET) · Wk 12 Buccaneers ~10.2 · Wk 14 Buccaneers ~10.1 · Wk 15 Buccaneers ~10.3 · Wk 16 Buccaneers ~11.3 · Wk 17 Buccaneers ~8.9.

No recommendation — nobody available fits.

### WR3 Won't Hold — WR3, Season-Long · Target 10.6 pts 02/3

Drops Off When Filled

Replacing a ~15: Wan'Dale Robinson becomes ~11 once Carnell Tate is back (listed Out (Shoulder)).

No recommendation — nobody available fits.

### The Flex Runs Thin — FLEX, Weeks 9-12, 14 Fill · Target 11.5 pts 02/5

Drops Off After Wk 14

Full strength ~14.9 (Gordon). Wk 9 Gordon ~11.6 (hard matchup vs DET) · Wk 10 Meyers ~11.5 (Gordon moves up to RB2, Meyers slides in) · Wk 11 Robinson ~10.6 (Gordon moves up to RB2, Robinson slides in) · Wk 12 Gordon ~12.3 · Wk 14 Kelce ~11.7 (Gordon has a worse matchup).

No recommendation — nobody available fits.

### A Tough Draw for the Quarterback Spot — QB, Week 10 Fill · Target 23.0 pts 26

Drops Off After Wk 10

Full strength ~23.1 (Prescott). Wk 10 Prescott ~23.0 (hard matchup vs SF).

No recommendation — nobody available fits.

### The Receiving Corps Runs Thin — WR1, Weeks 9, 14 Fill · Target 15.2 pts 05/2

Drops Off After Wk 14

Full strength ~16.6 (Flowers). Wk 9 Jefferson ~14.3 (Flowers moves up to WR2, Jefferson slides in) · Wk 14 Jefferson ~16.1 (Flowers moves up to WR2, Jefferson slides in).

No recommendation — nobody available fits.

**Also on the Board** TE, Weeks 9-10, 12, 17 Fill | RB2, Weeks 10-11 Fill | K, Weeks 10, 15 Fill | WR2, Week 13 Fill

## Gate 2 · Available, Could Incrementally Improve the Team

Found by workload, an opening, or a return · priced as if a seat opens · no drops suggested

None this run.

## Gate 3 · Hunches

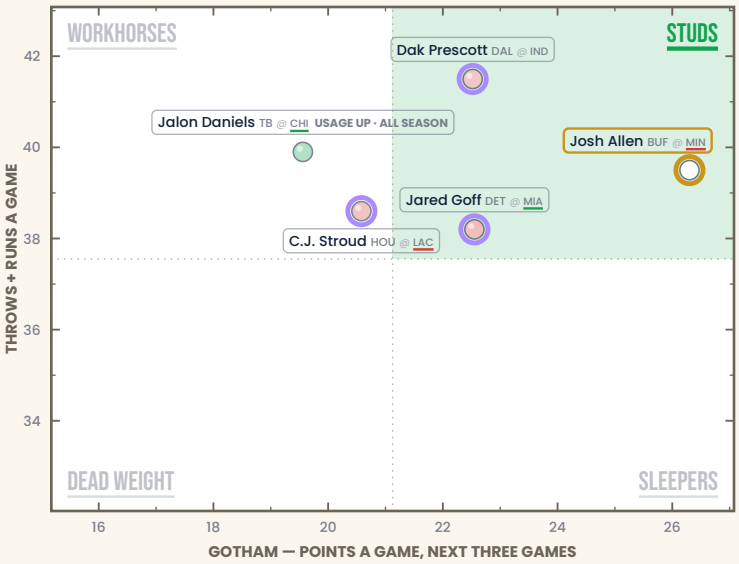
Written down, aged and graded like any other name

None written yet.

**Checked, Not Assumed** Robinson ~14.6 to ~10.6 from Wk 10 — Carnell Tate checked: rostered by Fly Eagles Fly (IR) · Can't claim: RJ Harvey (DEN RB) - you dropped him, and Yahoo blocks claiming back your own drop while he's on waivers. If nobody claims him he's a free agent after Nov 7 and you can add him then. · Can't claim: DEN defense (DEN DEF) - you dropped him, and Yahoo blocks claiming back your own drop while he's on waivers. If nobody claims him he's a free agent after Nov 7 and you can add him then. · Stash: Kenny Gainwell (TB RB, free agent) - 34% of the TB backfield's touches the last three games behind Bucky Irving (~17.2 a game, 60%); the lead job is his if Irving goes down; his own level now ~9.3 · Stash: Chris Rodriguez Jr. (JAX RB, free agent) - 31% of the JAX backfield's touches the last three games behind Bhayshul Tuten (~16.4 a game, 56%); the lead job is his if Tuten goes down; his own level now ~5.6 · Rising: Dylan Sampson (CLE RB, free agent) - workload jumped to 13.3 expected points last game from 3.5 before; season level ~9.0, not on the Scout's pickup list yet - one more game like it and he is · Rising: Tyler Allgeier (ARI RB, free agent) - workload jumped to 18.7 expected points last game from 8.9 before; season level ~10.0, not on the Scout's pickup list yet - one more game like it and he is · Adonai Mitchell (NYJ WR) is on the Positions chart (workload 6.5->9.7): adds nothing to the best lineup through Wk 17, real level ~10.7 a game; ranks below the picks above · Alvin Kamara (NO RB) is on the Positions chart (teammate out: Travis Etienne): adds nothing to the best lineup through Wk 17, real level ~11.0 a game; ranks below the picks above · Justice Hill (BAL RB) is on the Positions chart (workload 9.8->28.3; covers Wk11 Bijan Robinson, Wk10 D'Andre Swift): adds nothing to the best lineup through Wk 17, real level ~6.3 a game; ranks below the picks above · Kendre Miller (NO RB) is on the Positions chart (teammate out: Travis Etienne): adds nothing to the best lineup through Wk 17, real level ~10.2 a game; ranks below the picks above
Protected (Dom's call): Travis Kelce · Rosters Yahoo Wed Nov 4, 1:36 PM PT (API) · Stats nflverse Wed 1:36 PM PT

## QUARTERBACKS

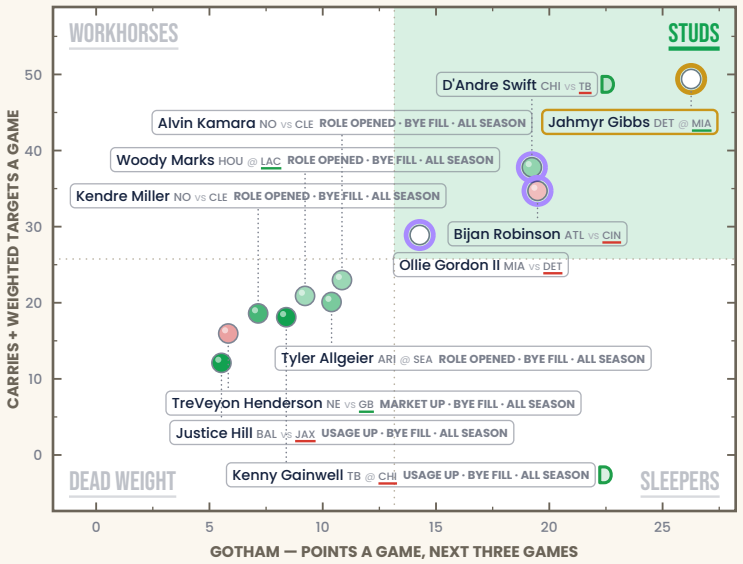
AS OF **WED NOV. 4, 1:13 PM**




**Floor:** 19.1 a game — 85% of Dak Prescott, the weakest starter here (22.5).
**Doors:** Jalon Daniels — workload 35.8->48.2

## RUNNING BACKS

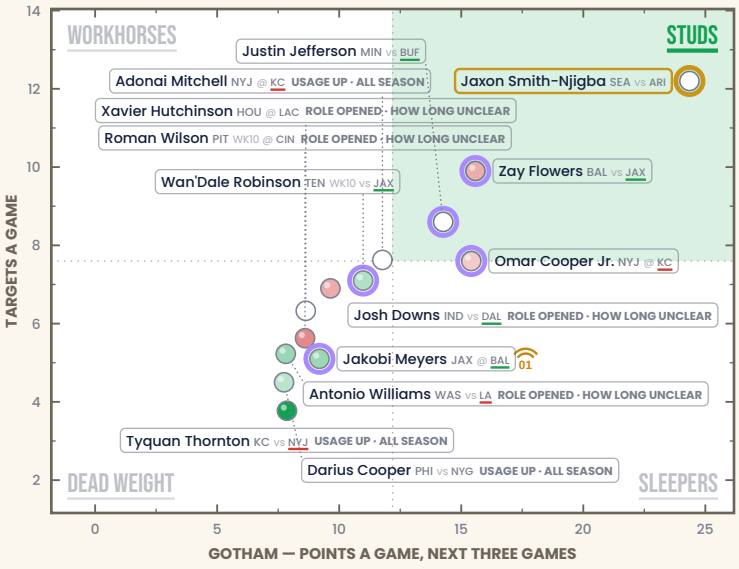
AS OF **WED NOV. 4, 1:13 PM**




**Floor:** 12.1 a game — 85% of Ollie Gordon II, the weakest starter here (14.3).
**Doors:** Alvin Kamara — teammate out: Travis Etienne; Tyler Allgeier — teammate down this week: Jeremiyah Love Out; Woody Marks — teammate out: David Montgomery; covers Wk11 Bijan Robinson, Wk10 D'Andre Swift; Kenny Gainwell — workload 12.7->27.7; covers Wk11…
**Check:** Sleeper far lower than Gotham — TreVeyon Henderson 5.8 vs 10.3. Look before acting.

## RECEIVERS

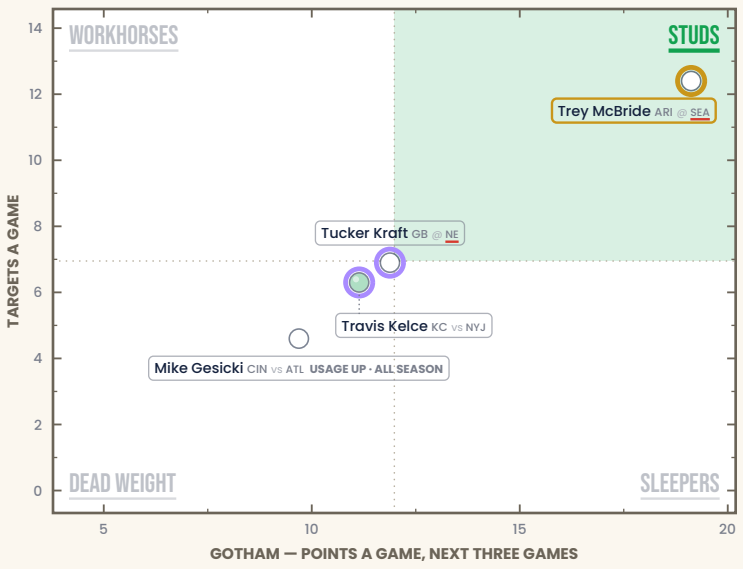
AS OF **WED NOV. 4, 1:13 PM**




**Floor:** 7.8 a game — 85% of Jakobi Meyers, the weakest starter here (9.2).
**Doors:** Adonai Mitchell — workload 6.5->9.7; Tyquan Thornton — workload 2.3->9.4; Josh Downs — teammate down this week: Alec Pierce Out; Xavier Hutchinson — teammate down this week: Jaylin Noel Out

## TIGHT ENDS

AS OF **WED NOV. 4, 1:13 PM**




**Floor:** 9.5 a game — 85% of Travis Kelce, the weakest starter here (11.1).
**Doors:** Mike Gesicki — workload 4.3->6.0

**Legend:** rising (pale = a little, deep = a lot) · falling (pink = a little, red = a lot) · new — no games yet · flat
violet ring = on this roster · gold ring = best at the position · BYE FILL / INJURY FILL = covers a bye or an injury on this roster
Movement = his last two games, the latest counting most, against his own earlier average. · SCOUT PICK = recommended on the Scout page
vs = home, @ = away (this week's opponent). Line under him: ___ hard ___ easy against this man's position; none = middle. Thursday's teams show next week's game.
Plate words: USAGE UP = workload jumped · ROLE OPENED = a teammate ahead of him is out (MAY OPEN = unconfirmed) · MARKET UP = sources well above Gotham
Marks beside a plate: drop order — red first, then gold, then grey · news this week — Radar page · D drift moved his workload · 1 on the Call Sheet

**How to read it:** Across = points going forward. Up = how much his team uses him. Lines = the middle of the rostered field. Studs = ahead on both.

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | GOLD | Worth doing — monitor, act when the trigger hits. | Call Sheet, item by number |
| 1 | GREEN | Confirmed — the move is agreed and dated. | Call Sheet, item by number |

## THE SIGNAL

The news mark · color = what the news is · digits = days since first seen

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| 04 | GREEN | Good news — full practice, off the report, back. | League page, The Radar |
| 04 | GOLD | Caution — questionable, limited, or a role change. | League page, The Radar |
| 04 | RED | Bad — out, doubtful, or did not practice with an injury. | League page, The Radar |
| 04 | GREY | Closed — nothing new; the story has gone quiet. | League page, The Radar |
| | SPLAT | A man never seen before — first day on the Radar. | League page, The Radar |
| 1/40 | 1/40 | A returner: 1 day back, after a 40-day gap. | League page, The Radar |
| 02 | FILLED | Two independent origins confirm it — the rule fired and the number moved. | Reason line under the number |
| 02 | HOLLOW | One origin only — arcs hollow, digits solid. No number moves until a second confirms. | Reason line under the number |

**Origin:** the reporter or document a story traces to, not the outlet. Five outlets repeating one beat writer is one origin.

## DROP CLUSTER

The cut order itself · there is no cut page · every drop is talked through before it is made

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | RED | First to go. Ranked below the number of men rostered at his position. | Field Report bench, Positions |
| | GOLD | Second to go. Injured men, IR, kickers and defenses are never marked. | Field Report bench, Positions |
| | GREY | Third to go. A handcuff or the only cover for a bye, Weeks 5-7, never prints red. | Field Report bench, Positions |

## TREND

Playing time, not points · his last two games against his earlier average · flat = no mark

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| ↗ | CLIMBING | Playing time rising. | Field Report, marker column |
| ↘ | FALLING | Playing time falling. | Field Report, marker column |

## D · DRIFT

Gotham changed his number · his role moved over his last two games · look in Gotham

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| D | D GREEN | Role growing. Takes the trend mark's place on his row. | Marker column, Positions plates |
| D | D RED | Role shrinking. Comes off on its own once the role settles. | Marker column, Positions plates |

## TEAM TIER

Hairline on the NFL abbreviation · ranked across all 32 teams by points scored

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| KC | RULE ABOVE | Top third of the league. | Everywhere a team prints |
| PIT | RULE BELOW | Bottom third — the whole bad-team warning. | Everywhere a team prints |
| WAS | CLEAN | Middle third. | Everywhere a team prints |

## WHY HE'S HERE

Positions page · the words on a free agent's plate · why he is on the chart, what he is for, how long

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| USAGE UP | His workload last game ran well above his earlier games. | Positions page, on his plate |
| ROLE OPENED | A teammate ahead of him is out or moved, confirmed. | Positions page, on his plate |
| ROLE MAY OPEN | Same, but only a missed practice so far, no designation. Watch it. | Positions page, on his plate |
| MARKET UP | The forecasters rate him well above what Gotham says. | Positions page, on his plate |
| BYE / INJURY FILL | He beats this roster's best cover for a starter on bye or out, Weeks 9-12. | Positions page, on his plate |
| ALL SEASON · 3 WEEKS | How long he should help. HOW LONG UNCLEAR when the opening has no end date. | Positions page, on his plate |
| SCOUT PICK | Recommended on the Scout page, plotted beside the men here. | Positions page, on his plate |

## THE SCOUT'S SPYGLASS

On the man a live Scout need is about · color = how urgent the need is · the Signal's life cycle: splat, then a day count

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| 03 | RED · GOLD | Red = act now, gold = watch. Splat = new today; 03 = three days on. | Field Report, Scout page |